

Every behavior plan is a *communication plan*.

Page one is the calm-day work. Page two is the storm.

FUNCTION IS A MESSAGE

FUNCTION	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE IN WORDS	WHAT HONORING IT LOOKS LIKE
Attention	talk to me, play with me, watch this, my turn	Respond to the message fast, on their schedule at first
Escape	too hard, break, not now, I need out	Grant it. Fade duration later, never reliability
Tangible	I want that, more, mine, give me	Honor when possible; otherwise acknowledge and give a when
Sensory	too loud, I need to move, that hurts	Change the environment before changing the student

Modeling, the one skill. Touch the words on their system as you say them, one or two key words only. Model to show, never to quiz. Then wait a silent ten count. A new AAC user deserves the same year of input a talking child gets before their first word.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

RETIRED	INSTEAD
"Use your words"	Model the word, then wait
"Use your device"	Model on the device, then wait
"Show me ____" as a quiz	Just talk, hands on the words
"He's just playing on it"	That is babbling. It is learning

THE PROMPT LADDER, LIGHTEST FIRST

- 1 Fix the environment. Device in reach, always
- 2 Pause. Ten to fifteen seconds, expectant face
- 3 Model it yourself
- 4 Gesture toward the area, not the button
- 5 Partial verbal: "you can tell me." Then stop

No hand-over-hand on communication devices. It builds waiting instead of learning, it makes the message yours instead of theirs, and it teaches a vulnerable student that adults may move their body without consent. Exceptions: immediate physical safety, and hand-under-hand written into a plan for motor or vision access, student's hand on top, steering. Support the arm, never the message.

Presume competence. Age-level talk, always. Never discuss a student in front of them as if they are not there. Understanding outruns output. A student's no, however it comes out, is communication we acknowledge, not a behavior we extinguish.

When words stop working, *point instead.*

During escalation the student cannot get words out and cannot take words in. Keep the channel open.

THE CURVE, AND THE BOARD'S JOB AT EACH POINT

PHASE	WHAT WORKS
Calm	Teaching. The only phase where new learning happens
Agitation	The student requests an exit, a break, or space
Acceleration	You reduce to two or three symbols. Stop adding words
Peak	Nothing works. Safety and presence only. Do not prompt
Recovery	The student explains without producing a spoken account

Three moves in the moment. Stop talking, three words or fewer. Model, never demand. Say yes: honor the request every time while teaching, because a board honored four times out of five teaches that the behavior is the more reliable option.

ON PROLOQUO2GO, ROW FOUR IS THE ROW



Intermediate Core, 60 buttons. Row 4, columns 1 to 4. One hit each. Column one is who. Row four is what you do about it.

Also one hit: **all done** at row 2, column 10. Two hits, adjacent: **not + more** = enough, row 1, columns 9 and 10.

THE FOLDER TRAP

Feelings cannot say stop. That page labels emotions and cannot refuse, request an exit, or call a person. Go Home first. Feelings is a second stop, to explain, after the message is out.



The VOICE check, five seconds, every shift. A device in the backpack during recess is a voice that cannot say stop. If any letter fails, fix it before the next activity starts.

The device stays in their hands. Removing it removes their voice. If it is unsafe in the moment, move it out of range and bring the paper backup forward; never keep it away as a consequence. And the escape answer, ready for when it comes up: the student already gets escape by screaming, every time. The button does not add escape. It changes which route delivers it. Fade duration later. Never fade reliability.